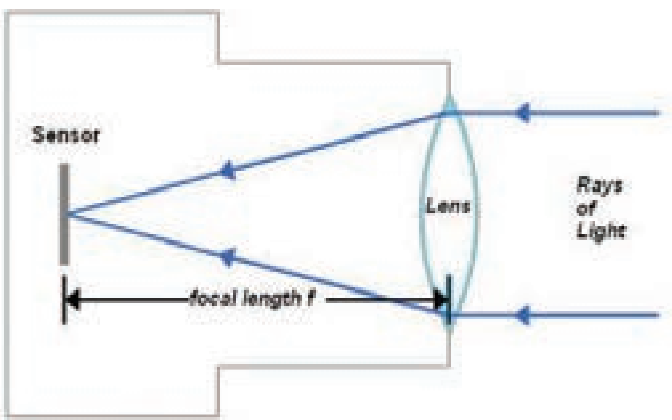
The 'leaf-shutter' kind of diaphragm is made of a number of thin overlapping blades

zines by the character 'f' followed by a number such as f/1.4, f/2, f/2.8 and so on. These are basically gradations that let you adjust the quantity of light or exposure for a particular shot. As you vary the f-stop values, you may notice an apparatus called the 'diaphragm' constricting or expanding behind the lens to permit a corresponding quantity of light.

Technically, an f-stop number is the focal length of the lens divided by the diameter of the aperture. Simply put, the f-number is the ratio of the size of the aperture that the light passes through, to the focal point of the lens.

Each f-number represents a halving of the light intensity from the previous stop and a decrease of the aperture diameter by a factor of v2 (around 1.414). Therefore, f/11 is half as much as f/8, and f/5.6 is twice as much light as f/8. Currently, most lenses use a standardised f-stop scale – which is a geometric sequence of numbers that correspond to the sequence of the powers of v2 – viz. f/1, f/1.4, f/2, f/2.8, f/4, f/5.6, f/8, f/11,



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